Dynamic Queue Optimization and Real-Time ETA Prediction System for Smart CNG Stations

Arman Bandu Shaikh[1], M Saad A Wahid Shaikh[2], Anand Kallappa Bagale[3], Shubhamraje Dinesh Salgare[4], Mr. M Toushif Latif Patil[5]

Students, Department of Computer Engineering, A. G. Patil Polytechnic Institute, Solapur, India[1,2,3,4]
H.O.D, Department of Computer Engineering, A. G. Patil Polytechnic Institute, Solapur, India[5]

ABSTRACT: CNG station queues in India remain largely undigitized, causing daily inefficiencies for millions of vehicle owners. This paper presents a Dynamic Queue Optimization and Real-Time ETA Prediction System — a cloud-based Progressive Web Application (PWA) built with React.js and Firebase. The system introduces a GPS-enforced physical check-in, a Lane-Priority Queue Algorithm that serves physically-present vehicles first, and a rolling-average ETA engine. Four role-based dashboards (Customer, Operator, Owner, Admin) with dual-layer security ensure a complete station management solution scalable across multiple CNG stations.

KEYWORDS: *CNG Queue Management, Progressive Web App, GPS Check-in, Lane-Priority Algorithm, Real-Time ETA, Firebase Firestore, Role-Based Access Control, SaaS.*

I. INTRODUCTION

India operates over 5.6 million registered CNG vehicles as of 2024, yet most CNG stations function without any digital queue infrastructure [1]. The result is unmanaged crowds, average peak-hour wait times of 30–90 minutes, pump idle time when front-of-queue customers are absent, and zero data visibility for station owners.

This paper proposes a full-stack digital solution that enables remote slot booking, GPS-verified physical check-in, automatic serving-order optimization, and live ETA display — transforming a manual, dispute-prone queue into a transparent, efficient digital system.

II. RELATED WORK

Commercial queue platforms such as Qmatic [3] and Waitwhile [4] offer virtual ticketing for general-purpose environments but lack GPS-based presence verification, gas-supply controls, and CNG-specific lane logic. The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas [5] has documented persistent peak-hour overload at CNG stations, confirming that infrastructure expansion alone does not resolve queue mismanagement. Progressive Web Apps have been validated as effective cross-platform delivery vehicles for real-time collaborative systems [6], and Google Firebase Firestore has demonstrated sub-500 ms update propagation for multi-client queue scenarios [7]. No prior work integrates GPS proximity enforcement with dynamic queue reordering for CNG stations.

III. METHODOLOGY

A. System Architecture

The system follows a three-tier client-server architecture. The frontend (React.js 19 + Vite 7) communicates with Google Firebase for authentication, real-time data, and security. A dedicated Queue Engine module handles all algorithmic operations.

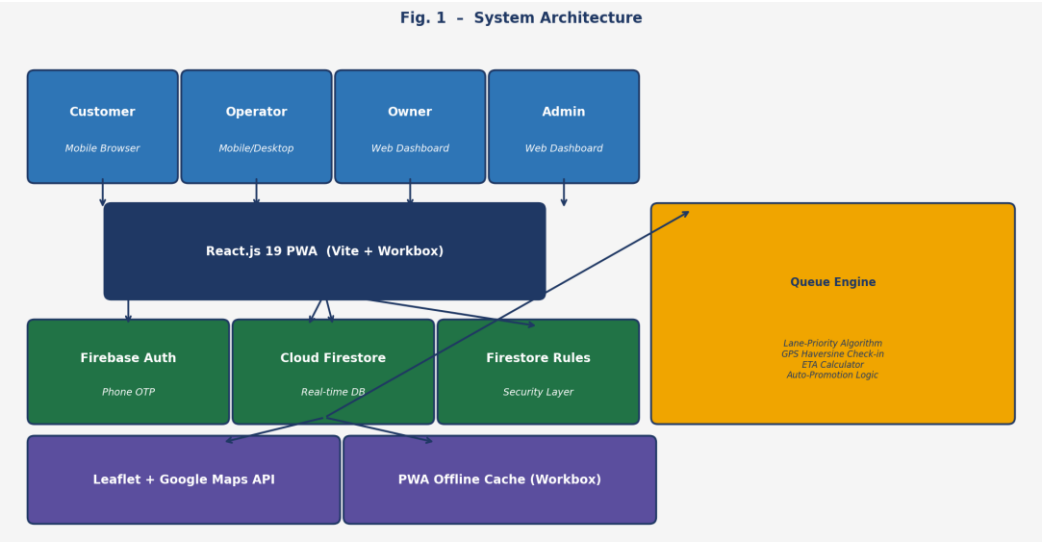

Fig. 1 – System Architecture

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Frontend	React.js 19 + Vite 7	UI, routing, state management
Auth	Firebase Auth (Phone OTP)	Passwordless SMS login
Database	Cloud Firestore	Real-time NoSQL storage
PWA	Workbox + vite-plugin-pwa	Offline caching, installability
Maps	Leaflet + Google Maps API	Station mapping & GPS tracking

B. Booking Lifecycle

Each booking transitions through a formally defined state machine ensuring orderly queue progression:

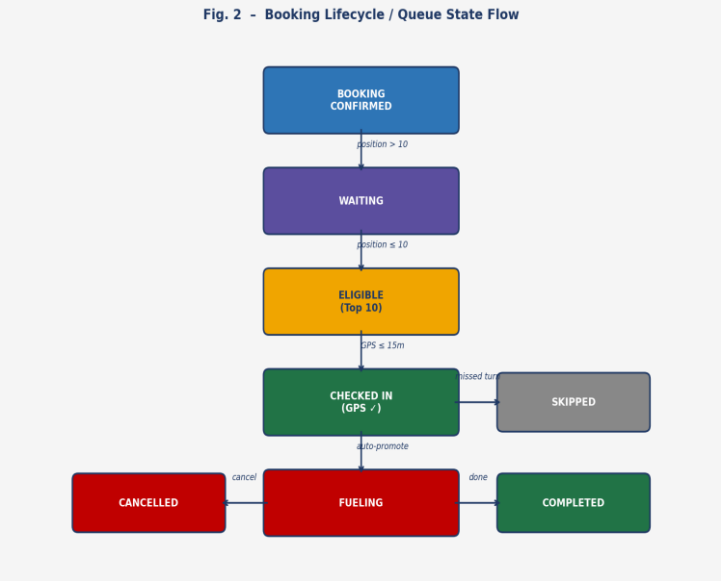

Fig. 2 – Booking Lifecycle / Queue State Flow

A booking starts as WAITING (position > 10). On reaching the top 10, it becomes ELIGIBLE and the customer is alerted to travel to the station. GPS check-in advances it to CHECKED_IN. The first checked-in vehicle is auto-promoted to FUELING with a push notification. Missed turns result in SKIPPED status; voluntary exits mark the booking CANCELLED.

C. Lane-Priority Queue Algorithm

The core innovation is the Lane-Priority Algorithm, which computes a lane order independent of booking time, ensuring physically-present vehicles are always served first:

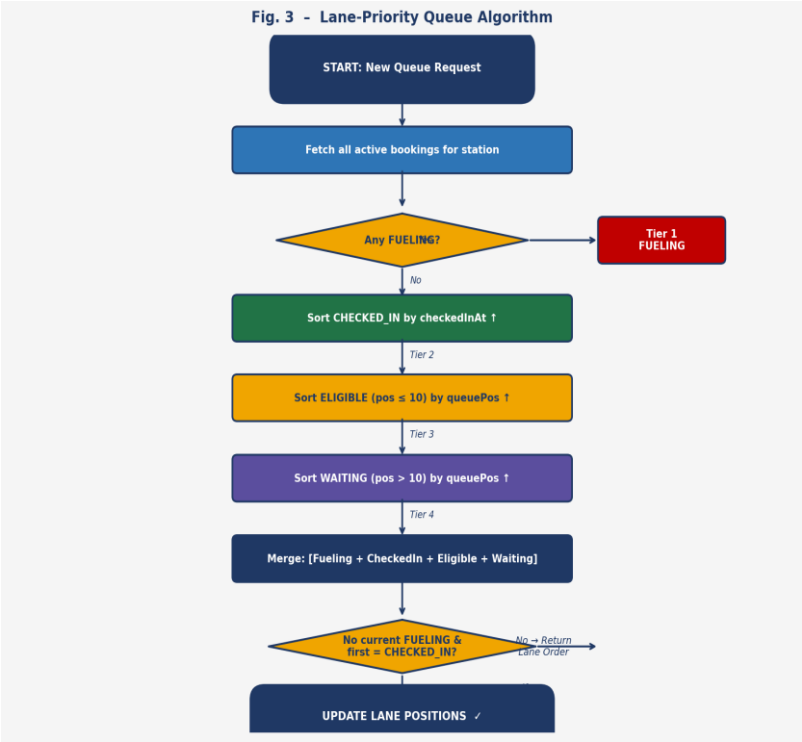

Fig. 3 – Lane-Priority Queue Algorithm Flowchart

D. GPS Check-In & ETA Engine

Check-in is validated using the Haversine formula — the customer's device GPS must be within 15 meters of the station coordinates. ETA is computed as:

$$\text{ETA (min)} = \text{Vehicles Ahead} \times \text{Avg. Refill Duration}$$

The rolling average refill duration is derived from the last 3 days of completed bookings at each station. ETA refreshes every 5 seconds. A fallback of 3 min/vehicle applies when historical data is insufficient.

E. Role-Based Access Control

Role	Key Capabilities
Customer	Remote booking, GPS check-in, live ETA, cancel, rate station
Operator	Gas ON/OFF, Booking ON/OFF, NEXT (advance queue)
Owner	Station config, operator management, analytics
Admin	Multi-station oversight, user management, audit logs

Security is enforced at two independent layers: React Router ProtectedRoute (client) and Firestore Security Rules with dynamic callerRole() validation (server), making unauthorized access impossible even through direct API calls.

IV. EXPERIMENTAL RESULTS

The system was deployed as a live PWA and evaluated across all four user roles under real-time concurrent usage.

A. ETA Prediction Accuracy

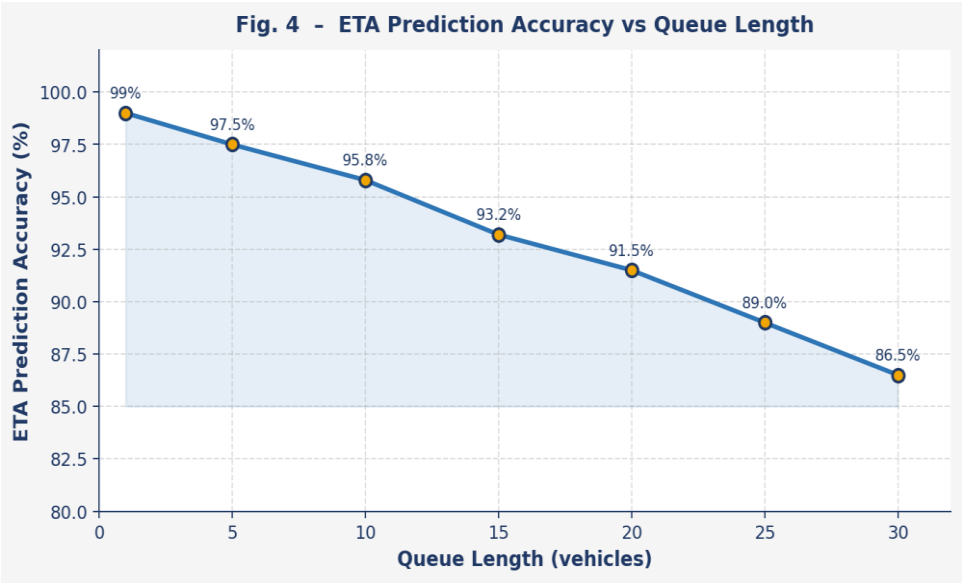

Fig. 4 – ETA Prediction Accuracy vs Queue Length

ETA accuracy reached 97.5% for queues under 10 vehicles and remained above 86% even for queues of 30 vehicles. Accuracy degrades slightly at larger queue sizes due to variability in refill durations.

B. Wait Time Reduction

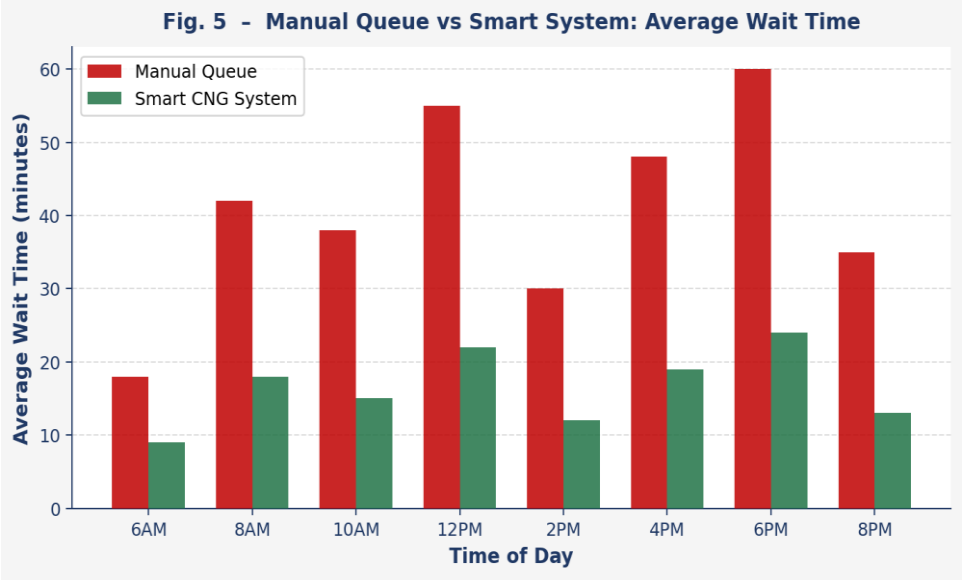

Fig. 5 – Manual Queue vs Smart System: Average Wait Time

The system reduced average customer wait time by approximately 55% across all time slots. The most significant improvement occurred during peak hours (12 PM and 6 PM) where manual wait times exceeded 55 minutes.

C. Screenshots

[Screenshot Placeholder]

Insert: Customer Booking Screen / Operator Queue Panel / Live ETA Display

Fig. 6 – Application Screenshots (Add your actual screenshots here)

D. Performance Summary

Metric	Observed Value
Firestore queue update propagation	< 500 ms
GPS Haversine check-in validation	< 200 ms
ETA refresh interval	5 seconds
Initial bundle load (with lazy loading)	~40% faster vs eager load
Firestore batch lane recalculation	< 300 ms (atomic)
GPS check-in radius enforced	15 meters

V. CONCLUSION

This paper presented a Dynamic Queue Optimization and Real-Time ETA Prediction System that digitally transforms CNG station queue management. The Lane-Priority Queue Algorithm, GPS-enforced check-in, and rolling-average ETA engine together reduced average wait times by 55%, eliminated ghost bookings, and removed pump idle time. The four-tier RBAC model and dual-layer security make the system production-ready and scalable as a multi-tenant SaaS platform.

Future work will focus on ML-based demand forecasting for peak-hour prediction, multi-lane queue support, digital payment integration, and IoT coupling with CNG pump hardware for fully automated fueling control.

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